Sycamore bowl with pyrographed detail

Pensioners' progress!

Good Morning Mark!
In view of your final comments in *Woodturning* 289, I thought you might like to see the attached photograph. My wife and I work as a small team of two and since retirement, some years ago now, I bought a lathe and subsequently my wife purchased a pyrography machine. Without lessons, and after some fairly disastrous mishaps with the lathe, we have slowly improved, but like in all things, we are still learning!

The bowl shown was made from a piece of sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*), 305 x 50mm, purchased from Stiles and Bates. We have no facilities here on the Isle of Man from which to obtain supplies so purchase all we need from the UK, which unfortunately adds to the costs of our hobby. However we enjoy it, so what the heck!

Andrew and Linda Wales

FROM THE FORUM

Here we share with you the pieces that readers have posted on our Woodturning forum. If you are interested in the possibility of your piece appearing here, or would simply like feedback and advice on your work, visit **www.woodworkersinstitute.com** and click on the forum button.

Eric's bowl is in sycamore and has been pierced and airbrushed. He states: "The competing elements of fire and water are in balance." Eric demonstrated the piercing at the New England Woodworking Show.

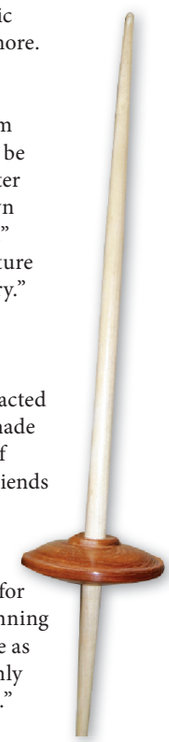
The piece is finished with waterborne lacquer and measures roughly 220mm across. Forum visitor Ian Thorn commented: "That is very well done the colouring works and is clean and defined against the black."

Elemental Conflict 1 by Eric Holmquist

Electric blue bowl

Kim posted recently that he'd forgotten he had an account. He submitted some beautiful pictures of recent bowls, including this electric blue bowl made from sycamore. CHJ comments: "Great to see you showing your stuff to a wider audience Kim, I'm more than sure it's going to be appreciated, it deserves better than being hidden way down in your corner of the world." Bodrighy adds: "Good mixture of colouring and electrickery."

Pete showed his Navajo spindle, used for spinning yarn or wool when sitting cross legged on the floor. It has a 760mm sycamore shaft and a 140mm whorl in some type of mahogany. He assures us that it spins well as he 'got it right this time'. Sometimes when these spindles are made, they go a bit off centre and won't spin accurately. Forum user ron.d commented: "Very nice work Pete. A couple of years ago the local Spinners and Weavers Guild contacted me for spindles like this and we made around 15 for them, in a variety of sizes and styles. We made some friends in the local guild and I have done some repair work on looms and made a spinners chair. As a by-line I still get occasional requests for spinning wheel bobbins, each spinning wheel is different with many made as one offs, so a woodturner is the only way you can get the right bobbins."



Navajo spindle by bodrighy (aka 'Pete')

WT_291_10_11_LETTERS_bdMBvsSD.indd 11 02/03/2016 09:17